Research to Brief System

A source-aware worksheet for turning scattered information into a clear brief.

HOW TO USE IT

Write directly on a printed copy or duplicate the prompts into your own notes. Synthetic examples are used. Do not paste confidential school, workplace, or personal data into AI tools.

1. Research question

Narrow the topic until evidence can change your decision.

- ■ Write one decision-focused question.
- ■ List three sub-questions that would resolve uncertainty.
- ■ Define the date range and geography.
- ■ Note which voices or perspectives may be missing.
- ■ Set a stopping rule for research.

2. Source ledger

Do not treat search results or AI summaries as evidence.

- ■ Record source title, publisher, date, and link.
- ■ Label primary, secondary, or opinion.
- ■ Capture the exact claim the source supports.
- ■ Check whether a newer source changes the picture.
- ■ Flag conflicts instead of hiding them.

3. Decision brief

Separate evidence from recommendation.

- ■ One-sentence decision or recommendation.
- ■ Three strongest findings with source references.
- ■ Material uncertainty and limitations.
- ■ Risks, tradeoffs, and affected people.
- ■ Next action, owner, and review date.

This resource supports learning and reflection. It is not legal, medical, financial, or professional advice. Verify important decisions with an appropriate qualified person.